

26 Aug 2026 13:51:39 ET | 15 pages

Kingboard Group

More Promising For Technology Curve Upgrade on AI-CCL Supply Chain

CITI'S TAKE

We hosted post-results investor meetings on 25-26 Aug including a group meeting drawing over 90 investors. Key takeaways are **1)** Hallgain (largest shareholder of KBH) started to raise stake despite a small vol start (see Fig 2), **2)** capex plan of KBH HK\$7bn (see Fig 1) this year mainly for AI-CCL supply chain to upgrade the technology curve which would prompt for PE re-rating, **3)** KBH & KBL retaining generous div policy, **4)** the record-high monthly profit run rate in July will likely sustain thru the rest of this year. **Reiterate Buy on KBL** for compelling valuation of 8-9x PE and 6% div yld for 2027E against **Grace Fabric** (China's largest specialty fibreglass fabric mfg) at >80x PE and **Nittobo** (Global largest T-glass fabric mfg) at >25x PE for 2027E per VA consensus. **We still prefer KB Laminate over KB Holdings** for stronger earnings momentum.

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Citi Industrial | SMID | Transport conference on 22-23 Sep in Conrad, HK- in conjunction with expert luncheon on **23 Sep at 12.00-13.00**. Topic is **Upstream Fibreglass Fabric and Copperfoil Development on AI-CCL Supply China**. Speaker is Jason Cheung, President of Global Marketing, R&D at Kingboard Laminates 1888.HK. Click [here](#) for registration.

Record high profit run rate in July will sustain thru end of this year – Per KBL 1H26 results report, the company delivered a record high monthly profit HK\$1.1bn for July. This has significantly escalated from monthly run rate of <HK\$300m in 1Q and >HK\$600m in 2Q. Mgmt believes this run rate should sustain through the rest of this year. This means upside to our conservative earnings estimate of HK\$9.3bn for full-year 2026E against HK\$2.89bn in 1H26.

1-2mth lag of actual profit to spot price – Some domestic investors thought the monthly spot prices of CCL / e-glass fabric would immediately reflect to profit run rate on that specific month. In reality, it would take about 1-2mths to take effect for price inflation given that KBL is working with over 1,600 customers. So a domestic broker mentioned monthly profit run rate at HK\$1bn in May (we estimate actual run rate of >HK\$600m per 1H26 results) but the company reported HK\$1.1bn in July.

Building 100m meters AI-fabric capacity in 2028E – KBL now operates 5 kilns (1 for low Dk gen 1, 2 for low Dk gen 2, and 2 for T-glass) for producing specialty fibreglass yarn for mfg of AI-fabric. As such, the customer certification has been extended to **Doosan, Shengyi Tech, TUC** now compared with **EMC and Panasonic** only in the last year. The company will build another 8 kilns by 2027 to bring total 100m meters AI-fabric in 2028 including 78m meters in Qingyuan. If this materializes, KBL will become the global leading AI-fabric mfg in 2028E which will account for 20%+ market share per mgmt.

See Appendix A-1 for Analyst Certification, Important Disclosures and Research Analyst Affiliations.

Looms tight supply will likely last for end of 2027 – One of the key bottlenecks on fibreglass fabric is weaving looms. KBL mentioned to secure almost all of **Toyota** looms in coming two years would take an addition of 2,500 units from 3,333 units in 2025 to 5,833 units in 2028E. The expected delivery quantity is 400 units in 2026E, 1,100 units in 2027E and 1,000 units in 2028E. Mgmt shows high confidence in securing them on schedule.

Risk of domestic looms to catch up Toyota looms? – Some investors are concerned domestic looms technology will catch up Toyota looms within coming 2yrs. Note Toyota holds a dominant position as ~90% global market share of high-end weaving looms for knitting electronic fibreglass fabric. Mgmt has conducted due diligence for other brands including **Tsudakoma (6217.TT)** and other Chinese brands. Domestic looms may not be compatible for Toyota looms for mfg of specialty fibreglass fabric due to lower yld, lower efficiency but much higher energy consumption. But domestic ones are able to make fabric for home appliances at this stage. Tsudakoma ones have much higher energy consumption but lower efficiency too.

Room for further surge of ASP on CCL – The spot price of CCL has doubled YTD from ~Rmb150/sheet in end-2025 to over Rmb310/sheet now after the latest price inflation of 10% in Aug. This has recently surpassed the last peak of spot price close to Rmb300/sheet in 2021. Mgmt sees there is still ample room for further ASP inflation on CCL due to current new AI vertical on this cycle but no new verticals in last cycle in 2021 but just led by COVID supply disruption.

Margin contraction on PCB segment in 1H26 is a matter of timing issue – PCB segmental EBITDA margin contracted to 15.4% in 1H26 from 18.9% in 1H25. Mgmt attributed this to timing issue as PCB takes more time to pass through cost inflation of CCL. Despite a small fraction of PCB exposure related to AIDC, KBL enjoys vertical integration strength now since promising delivery of PCB becomes crucial competitive advantages now amid material shortage. We thus expect PCB EBITDA margin should retore back to expansion mode for full-year 2026 since company has recently raised ASP massively by 20-60% subject to different end-applications.

Retaining generous dividend policy – KBL interim dividend payout at 30% is lower than usual 50%+ on full-year payout. Mgmt suggests capital allocation into capex over the interim period and will retain generous policy. We believe KBL will stick with full-year payout 50%+ for this year.

Figure 1. Expansion plan of KBH (capex HK\$7bn for 2026) including KBL (capex HK\$4bn in 2026)

Business	Segment	Project & Capacity	Location	Expected Completion / Commissioning
Electronics	Electronic Glass Fiber Yarn	70,000 tpa production line as material for mfg of traditional e-glass fabric	Shaoguan, Guangdong	Commissioned June 2026
		8 kilns for special electronic-yarn as material for mfg of AI-fabric	Qingyuan, Guangdong	2026-2027
		10,000 tpa ultra-fine electronic yarn project for advanced fibreglass fabric	Lianzhou, Guangdong	Commissioning Q1 2027
	Electronic Glass Fiber Fabric	95m meters/year project as traditional e-glass fabric	Shaoguan, Guangdong	Commissioning Q3 2026
		150m meters/year project as traditional e-glass fabric	Nansha District, Guangzhou, Guangdong	Commissioning Q3 2027
		78m meters/year as AI-fabric, bring total 100m meters in 2028	Qingyuan, Guangdong	Commissioning 1H2027
	Copper Clad Laminate (CCL)	1.1m sheets/month CCL + 20,000 rolls/month prepreg (PP); Phase 1: 350,000 sheets	Pingxiang, Jiangxi	Phase 1 commissioning mid-2027
		4.2m sheets/year (was 2.4m), mainly M6-grade or above high-end laminates	Kaiping, Guangdong	Commissioning Q1 2027
	Copper Foil	21,000 tpa, mainly RTF and upto HVLP4 copper foil	Qingyuan, Guangdong	Q3 2027
	Printed Circuit Board (PCB)	Expansion of 3.6m sq ft/year, mainly multilayer boards and HDI	Kaiping, Guangdong	Completion by end-2027
		1.1m sq ft/month; Phase 1: 600,000 sq ft/month	Gia Binh, Bac Ninh Province, Vietnam	Phase 1 commissioning Q4 2026
		1.2m sq ft/month; Phase 1: 600,000 sq ft/month	Ayutthaya, Thailand	Phase 1 completion 2027
Chemicals	Chemicals	340,000 tpa caustic soda; Phase 1: 200,000 tpa	Beihai, Guangxi	Phase 1 commissioned June 2026

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Remark : Bold words means AI- CCL supply chain

Source: Citi Research, Company Reports

Figure 2. Hallgain (largest shareholder of KBH) started to raise stake after end of blackout period though a small vol as start

Date	Shares Bought/(Sold)	Avg Price (HK\$)	Transaction Value (HK\$)	Total Interest (shares)	% of Issued Shares	Δ Stake (pp)
2026 Transactions						
25-Aug-2026	300,000	50.4337	15,130,110	354,129,400	31.56%	+0.02
07-Jul-2026	-5,000,000	83.6654	-418,327,000	353,829,400	31.54%	-0.44
06-Jul-2026	-9,328,000	90.3930	-843,185,904	358,829,400	31.98%	-0.83
03-Jul-2026	-7,560,000	101.2920	-765,767,520	368,157,400	32.81%	-0.68
02-Jul-2026	-9,127,000	104.0420	-949,591,334	375,717,400	33.49%	-0.81
30-Jun-2026	-4,000,000	119.4610	-477,844,000	384,844,400	34.30%	-0.36
29-Jun-2026	-10,593,500	118.0660	-1,250,732,171	388,844,400	34.66%	-0.94
26-Jun-2026	1,170,000	128.7000	150,579,000	399,437,900	35.60%	+0.10
25-Jun-2026	-22,686,500	128.9900	-2,926,331,635	398,267,900	35.50%	-2.02
24-Jun-2026	-25,352,500	127.9300	-3,243,345,325	420,954,400	37.52%	-2.26
23-Jun-2026	-22,028,500	131.3800	-2,894,104,330	446,306,900	39.78%	-1.96
22-Jun-2026	-20,000,000	140.3300	-2,806,600,000	468,335,400	41.74%	-2.76
20-Apr-2026	1,530,000	42.2865	64,698,345	493,289,200	44.50%	+0.13
17-Apr-2026	1,457,000	40.8911	59,578,333	491,759,200	44.37%	+0.14
16-Apr-2026	2,030,000	39.7126	80,616,578	490,302,200	44.23%	+0.18
15-Apr-2026	18,500	40.1692	743,130	488,272,200	44.05%	0.00
13-Apr-2026	1,692,000	39.9242	67,551,746	488,253,700	44.05%	+0.15
10-Apr-2026	1,536,500	37.6059	57,781,465	486,561,700	43.90%	+0.14
08-Apr-2026	2,029,500	35.7600	72,574,920	485,025,200	43.76%	—
2026 Subtotal	-123,912,500	Buy 48.4 / Sell 122.2	-16,006,575,591		-12.20%	-12.20
2025 Subtotal	6,999,000	27.3229	191,232,827		+0.57%	+0.57

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Source: Citi Research, Company Reports, HKEx

Kingboard Holdings

(0148.HK; HK\$49.58; 1; 26 Aug 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our HK\$125 target price is based on a PE-based sum-of-the-parts (SOTP) valuation methodology. We employ SOTP valuation given KB's different business lines, implying ~12x 2027E PE for the group from prior 19x PE at +4SD. We employ a lower earnings multiple to reflect recent market growing concerns over sustainability of AI capex due to worsening FCF generation among global hyperscalers. Nonetheless, we still use +1.5SD above its mean; we believe this is justified by the business upcycle in both laminate and PCB businesses. In our SOTP, we value the Laminate at 20x PE (at +1.5SD and in line with our TP target of KBL), PCB at 8x PE (about half of regional comps avg for KB without entry into NVDA chain but most regional comps do) and Chemical at 6x (~50% discount to Asian comps on account of smaller scale). For valuing the Property segment, we assume average 7% rental yield per current return for estimating the NAV of its rental property portfolio and property book value of HK\$12.2bn in 2026E. Our target price translates into ~12x 2027E P/E, which is +1.5SD over its historical mean since 2011 (range: 4.4x to 24.4x). Our target price translates into ~2x 2027E book value, which is still well below regional comps average of 7x PB.

Risks

We see the following risks that could impede the stock from reaching our target price: 1) slower-than-expected AI-CCL and AI-PCB contribution, 2) slower-than-expected consumption recovery could drag consumption of electronic goods/big ticket items like autos, home appliances, and smartphones, 3) lower-than-expected GDP growth in China; and 4) lower-than-expected oil prices.

Kingboard Laminates Holdings

(1888.HK; HK\$39.76; 1H; 26 Aug 26; 16:10)

Valuation

Our target price for KBL shares of HK\$95 is based on a ~20-21x P/E for 2027E, at +1.5SD over mean. We employ a premium (+1.5SD) over mean to reflect the growing % of its AI-fabric new business from 2H26E which should trigger re-rating along with further earnings upgrade possibility on e-glass fabric given higher run-rate of price inflation in June. We think the premium is justified as we expect a continued GM expansion cycle during 2026E-28E along with potential earnings upgrades given KBL would expand its customer base for AI-fabric under the NVDA and ASIC ecosystem this year. We think a PE methodology appropriately captures the company's medium-term operating performance. Our target price translates to 0.2-0.3x PEG (regional comp around 0.6x) backed by strong three-year earnings CAGR of 94% thru 2028E. We think this appears undemanding compared with regional CCL comps.

Risks

Our quant model gives a High Risk rating on the stock due to high stock price volatility. In terms of fundamentals, upside/downside risks that could cause the stock to exceed/underperform our target price include: 1) faster/ slower-than-expected demand on upstream materials such as glass fabric and copper foil on AI-related products; 2) China macro growth performs faster/slower-than-expected; 3) stronger/weaker-than-expected stimulus policies in China; or 4) recovery/weakness in end-demand of electronic goods.

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Appendix A-1

ANALYST CERTIFICATION

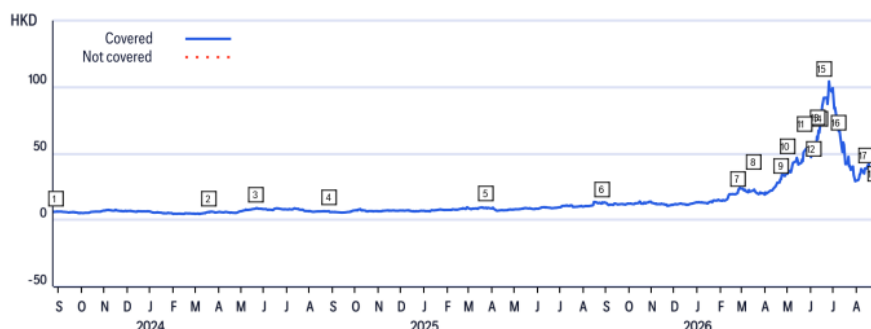
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IMPORTANT DISCLOSURES

Kingboard Laminates Holdings (1888.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Eric Lau



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 28-Aug-23 11:03:13	1	*9.95	6.22
2 18-Mar-24 13:55:33	1	*8.16	6.00
3 20-May-24 16:10:28	1	*12.44	8.50
4 26-Aug-24 12:52:14	1	*11.45	6.67
5 24-Mar-25 13:48:33	1	*13.94	9.23
6 25-Aug-25 14:05:25	1	*20.41	12.24

*Indicates Change

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
7 23-Feb-26 11:49:32	1	*27.87	20.29
8 16-Mar-26 17:59:34	1	*29.86	22.10
9 22-Apr-26 09:32:35	1	*42.80	30.72
10 03-May-26 18:02:15	1	*50.77	34.54
11 25-May-26 19:33:53	1	*65.70	50.87
12 03-Jun-26 08:03:10	1	*75.65	54.00

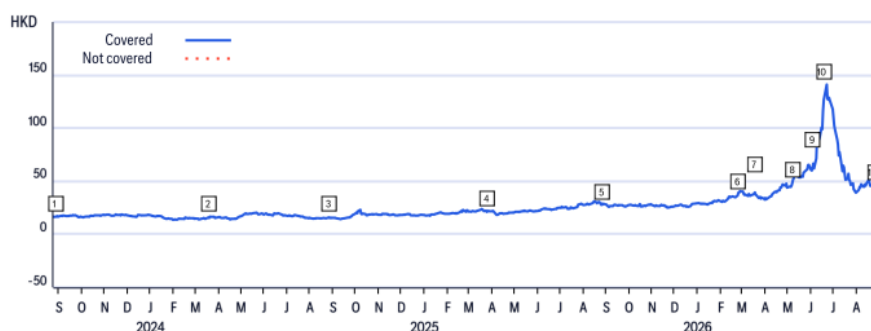
Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
13 08-Jun-26 10:05:51	1	*79.63	55.69
14 14-Jun-26 17:16:22	1	*100.00	65.60
15 18-Jun-26 00:33:31	1	*120.00	91.85
16 06-Jul-26 04:51:13	1	*130.00	73.85
17 12-Aug-26 12:45:21	*1H	*92.00	38.70
18 24-Aug-26 13:46:39	1H	*95.00	35.10

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Kingboard Holdings (0148.HK)

Ratings and Target Price History Fundamental Research

Analyst: Eric Lau



Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
1 28-Aug-23 12:55:58	1	*34.95	16.66
2 18-Mar-24 21:59:40	1	*29.87	15.89
3 26-Aug-24 13:55:22	1	*26.88	15.93
4 25-Mar-25 03:36:46	1	*29.47	21.06

*Indicates Change

Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
5 25-Aug-25 19:02:21	1	*35.84	27.70
6 23-Feb-26 11:50:02	1	*44.80	36.66
7 18-Mar-26 10:55:00	1	*47.79	39.41
8 07-May-26 19:05:58	1	*64.71	48.41

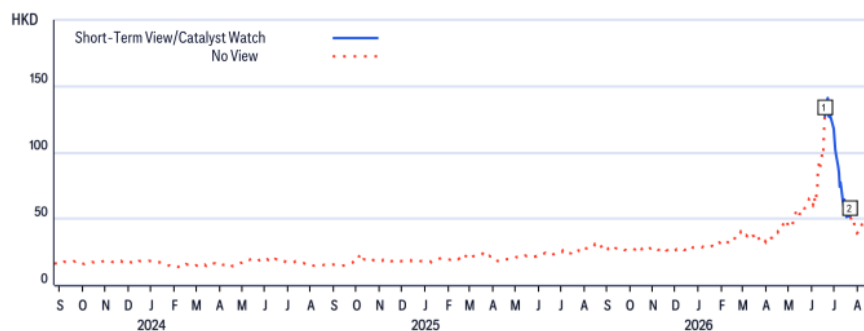
Date	Rating	Target Price	Closing Price
9 03-Jun-26 13:30:12	1	*89.60	62.47
10 21-Jun-26 20:40:54	1	*202.00	126.60
11 24-Aug-26 20:06:17	1	*125.00	45.58

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Kingboard Holdings (0148.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Eric Lau



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	21-Jun-26 16:40:54	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	126.60

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
2	22-Jul-26 00:35:52	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	51.25

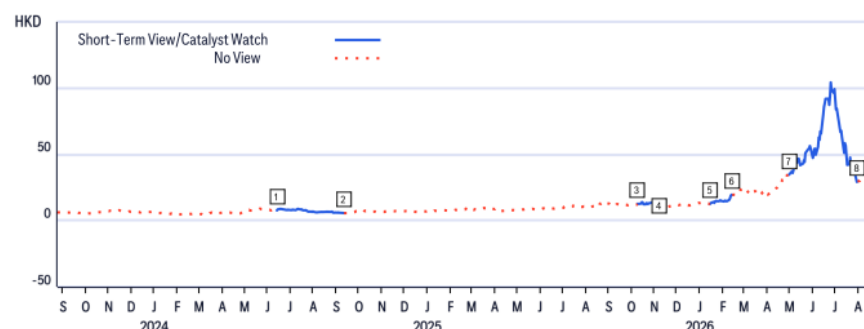
CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

Kingboard Laminates Holdings (1888.HK)

Short-Term View/Catalyst Watch Research

Analyst: Eric Lau



	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
1	13-Jun-24 06:22:03	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	7.63
2	11-Sep-24 00:14:59	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	5.59
3	09-Oct-25 07:10:54	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.56

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
4	07-Nov-25 12:06:35	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	11.85
5	14-Jan-26 03:04:03	Add CW	Upside	30 Days	12.40
6	13-Feb-26 12:13:30	Remove CW	Upside	30 Days	19.29

	Date	Action	Expected Direction	Duration	Closing Price
7	03-May-26 14:02:15	Add CW	Upside	90 Days	34.54
8	31-Jul-26 14:06:17	Remove CW	Upside	90 Days	29.42

CW - Catalyst Watch, STV - Short-Term View

Rating/target price changes above reflect Eastern Time

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